

Getting Newcastle University's campuses ready before term began

How a coordinated refresh of Teams Rooms, managed print and campus wireless gave thousands of returning staff and students a connected, reliable start to the academic year.

Scope	Deadline	Services	Foundation
Campuses and student halls	Start of academic term	Teams Rooms, print, wireless	Servers, apps, policy

Overview

Newcastle University ran a major technology programme to modernise collaboration, connectivity and print across its academic and residential estate.

The result was a unified digital environment built on Microsoft Teams Rooms, a refreshed Managed Print Service and a full Wireless Access Point (AP) deployment. Robust backend server builds, application configuration and policy creation supported all three, and everything had to land in time for the start of the new academic term.

The challenge

The work spanned multiple campuses and student halls, so it needed precise coordination. Every system had to be operational before the term began, when thousands of staff and students would return and expect teaching, research and administration to run without interruption.

The approach

The programme treated the three visible services and the infrastructure beneath them as one delivery. Backend server builds and policy creation ran in parallel with service rollout so that everything met the same term-start readiness milestone.

Each workstream shipped with the materials needed to run it afterwards: operational manuals, configuration templates, deployment runbooks and early-life support documentation.

What was delivered

Teams Rooms

- Designed and implemented Microsoft Teams Rooms across lecture theatres, meeting spaces and collaboration hubs.
- Integrated video conferencing, content sharing and room-booking systems with the university's Microsoft 365 environment.
- Delivered end-to-end configuration, testing and user adoption support.
- Authored operational manuals, service descriptions and knowledge-base articles for ongoing support.
- Reached full readiness before term, supporting seamless hybrid teaching and collaboration.

Managed print refresh

- Rolled out a Managed Print Service across all faculties and administrative departments.
- Consolidated legacy print infrastructure into a secure, cost-efficient, cloud-managed platform.
- Implemented print-release, cost-tracking and sustainability reporting features.
- Created governance policies for print access, data protection and environmental compliance.
- Completed deployment within the pre-term window, keeping service uninterrupted for staff and students.

Wireless access point deployment

- Deployed new enterprise-grade wireless access points across multiple campuses and student halls.
- Designed and tested coverage models for high-performance connectivity for academic and residential users.
- Integrated the APs with centralised monitoring and network-access control (NAC) systems.
- Delivered configuration templates, deployment runbooks and early-life support documentation.
- Completed the rollout under strict time constraints, with full coverage in place before students arrived.

Backend infrastructure and application configuration

- Built and configured backend servers supporting Teams Rooms, print management and wireless operations.
- Implemented application policies, authentication frameworks and configuration baselines.
- Delivered automated deployment scripts and monitoring dashboards for system health and performance.
- Ensured compliance with university IT security and data-protection standards.
- Coordinated parallel server builds and policy creation to meet the term-start milestone.

Outcomes

- Modernised collaboration and communication across academic and administrative functions.
- Enhanced wireless coverage and reliability across all campuses and student halls.

- Reduced print costs and improved sustainability through managed print optimisation.
- Stronger IT governance and operational efficiency through unified policy frameworks.

All services were delivered on schedule for the start of the new academic term, with zero disruption to teaching and operations.

Strategic impact

The programme established a connected, collaborative and sustainable digital campus. Delivered under significant time pressure, it gave staff and students modern tools, reliable connectivity and streamlined services, and positioned the university for continued innovation in teaching, research and digital engagement.